up when faced with authoritarian regimes in the Middle East and perhaps also in the case of Eastern Europe. This perceived weakness of Europe and its liberal democracy, the lack of will to sacrifice for its professed values, portrayed, in the eyes of Central Europe, a picture of Western Europe that is strong on individual rights and liberties, and on safeguarding a high level of living standards at home, but weak when trying to uphold these values outside its own territory. Furthermore, the focus of the societies in the West has not been anymore on political and basic human rights (so important for newly emerged democracies, but in the West now taken for granted), but increasingly on the intimate world of an atomised individual, his rights and liberties, however peculiar, specific and distinct, put high on the altar of the new secular religion, whose high priests reside not anymore in the now abandoned churches, but in a dense network of independent institutions, arts and NGOs. This was now another world – Charles Taylor's secular age.

A look at the Atlas of European Values[105] confirms this growing gap between the two halves of Europe – and the changed character of Western Europe. Ethically sensitive or philosophically relevant issues like religion and God, race and nationality, immigration, homosexuality and family and abortion, trust, equality, the death penalty, etc. show – usually though not always – a markedly different pattern of popular opinion in Central and Eastern Europe, compared with the West. (There are, however, also cases when the CEE pattern is similar to the South European one, and there are also differences in public opinion among the three tiers of Eastern Europe.)

What is important here is the realisation that this post-modern, 'woke' Europe was not anymore the one that Central Europeans thought they were subscribing to in the early 1990s, the one with classic liberal values and still some appreciation for Christian identity, the one known to those conservative EU-enthusiasts. No, it became a Europe unsure of its identity, repudiating the last remaining signs of its Christian and even Humanistic and classical liberal roots for the sake of greater inclusivity in an increasingly diverse society: '…suddenly, Poles have discovered that Western "normality" means secularism, multiculturalism and gay marriage.'[106] These were values and concepts that were, at best, of only secondary interest in Central Europe. Moreover, the way they were promoted caused fear that they want to replace conservative values appreciated in the region and change the identity of Europe as a whole.